

THE KANJOOS CHEATSHEET

You have finally reached the finish line of our kanjoos tech tips. You don't have to wait for Diwali deals to indulge into your favourite gadget wants. Here's our wishlist for the miserly who believe in spending less but getting the maximum value.

BY ABHIJIT DEY

If you have read the past two cover story pieces, then you must have received ample kanjoos tech hacks. Not only have you learnt how to wisely manage your finances and make every penny count, but with the previous story you have also been introduced to smart and stingy ways of enabling tech in your life. Here we try to give you very good alternatives to highly desirable but ridiculously expensive products in popular categories. Not all of us can afford the greatest smartphone, the best camera, or a kickass gaming laptop. But we don't have to. Read further to find out how you can settle on less expensive alternative gadgets that offer close-to-best in class performance in their categories.

You may laugh at our suggestion but this is no joke. Is it necessary to spend money on premium gadgets and software services? No. Can you survive by being fully dependent on cheaper alternatives? Yes. You can expect premium features to be present on cheaper and free alternatives (talking about software). In fact, you might even observe professional grade features present on free and open source software alternatives. Of course, compromises are bound to happen and this is where we jump in to reduce them by recommending the best products under a budget. You can obviously survive with cheap gadgets and free/open source software, and this is what the story tries to bring into perspective.

GADGETS

Let's kick things off with gadgets. Our labs have been adorned with hundreds of exuberant and expensive products. We admit that we've been spoilt by choice and we do hold high standards for several product categories. Having observed critical test processes involving both real world and synthetic scenarios, we can strongly conclude that you will do just fine with products that are cheap. By cheap we don't mean the ones built with unacceptable quality of components but the ones invested with informed compromises to meet a budget. Being a Digit reader, you're already aware that poorly performing products have been critically busted in our reviews. So, you can be assured that our recommendations are worth your money. We'll also look at certain gadget categories whether you actually need them and the explore the existence of alternatives.



The OnePlus Two is robust enough to be your daily driver

Smartphones

In this age, you'd be classified as an outlier and looked down upon if you don't own a smartphone. Considering the volatile nature of the market, buying a new smartphone is a tedious challenge. And the worst part comes when better phones at better prices are released just after you've bought yourself one. This is inevitable in such a competitive category spread across a wide price range. Yes, the best smartphones cost somewhere around ₹50-60k but do you actually need one? Chinese smartphone manufacturers have rattled up the market with their cheap and powerful devices. The most noise was made by OnePlus and their latest offering, the Two packs premium features and is still surprisingly priced at ₹25k. The reason this phone has been receiving so much appreciation is because the internal components are seen on other premium smartphones. The Snapdragon

810 SoC is present on several flagship smartphones and it has fared well against Samsung's Exynos 7420 and Apple's A9. Obviously, not better but the performance offered is enough to enjoy all high-end games and apps without any visible lag or drop in performance. The camera sensor is really good and even though it falls short against the Honor 7, priced